

Project Report

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Introduction

Digital Literacy is a very important skill needed for students in this modern world. Almost everywhere be it academic, professional or in any social activity we need to involve the usage of digital technologies such as computers, smartphones as well as online platforms. Being digitally illiterate actually means that not able to understand as well as know how to use such advance technologies. It is important to have crucial idea regarding such technologies as we need them to communicate responsibly as well as stay safe online also.

In this digital literacy portfolio project, I have completed a total of five tasks which mainly focused on digital awareness as well as online professionalism. The first task was to create an infographic. Secondly, I created a digital portfolio by setting up platforms such as GitHub as well as LinkedIn. The third task which I was involved in was exploring coding practice platforms as well as using the google forms. In the task 4 I will focus on writing professional emails as well as creating a responsible social media checklist. Also, the fifth task was to research on a cybercrime case study and also develop a prevention guide.

Overall, this project helped me a lot in understanding how digital tools can be used very effectively for an academic growth, professional development as well as responsible participation.

Task – 1

To Create a Digital Literacy Awareness Infographic:-

Created Via Canvas: -

In order to create the infographic, I took the help of the platform called as Canva. The main reason to use Canva is that it is very simple as well as easy to use due to a plenty of reasons such as the combinations of colors, fonts, icons as well as plenty of templates. Due to these advanced features, I was able to design my work neatly without knowing the knowledge of advanced technical skills.

Features of Infographics: -

The infographic which is created is mainly divided into three sections which are:- Digital Literacy, safe internet practices professional online presence, and email etiquette. In the first section which is known as Digital Literacy, the main focus was on to discuss the ability to use digital devices such as computers and smartphones. It also explains the importance of understanding online information, identifying either correct or incorrect information as well as communicating responsibly on any platform.

In the second section which is also known as Safe Internet Practices, the main focus was on understanding as well as using the technology properly and responsibly. It also includes important and necessary skills such as online research, critical thinking as well as producing content in a proper and right way. It was necessary to also consider the accountable part of the infographic.

I also added a section on email etiquette, which is necessary to highlight the use of proper subject lines in a polite and a very concise manner along

with also showcasing the need of proofreading the emails before sending them to any other person. This is crucial and necessary in order to become or do better in communication. While Designing, I used very simple language along with proper headings and use of icons and good colour patterns. Also, one thing I could observe was that while putting information in a concised manner it becomes easy to understand and remember the content.

Difficulty in Creating Infographics: -

While it was very interesting the infographic, it was not simple and easy to create the infographic. I did find it slightly difficult in several places. It was not easy to manage the limited space while covering and including all the important points. I also had to check and carefully decide which information was crucial to be displayed and which was not. It was not simple to maintain the balance between the texts and visuals so that the design does not look congested. Also, it took me a lot of time to get the colours, fonts as well as the template correct.

Task – 2

To Build our Student Digital Portfolio:-

Platforms Chosen and Their Roles:

In the second task, I have created and along with that also updated my profiles on platforms such as Github, LinkedIn and Kaggle to establish a strong digital as well as professional presence so that I can begin my journey in the field of computer science. These platforms are very crucial and widely used in the tech industry and will also play a very crucial and important role in the development of my skills and career growth.

- **GitHub:** It is a very powerful platform which is widely used for controlling versions, collaborating as well as hosting of projects. I have created a README repository which includes important information about me such as details regarding my name, branch and year in which I am studying. Over the next four years, I plan and aim to consistently display/upload my projects regarding different coding projects, including collage assignments, personal projects and experiments. After creating github I will also focus on improving my skills in Git, and contribute to several projects. This also helps me a lot in creating a strong portfolio which can in the future showcase my abilities.

- **LinkedIn:** It is a professional platform which is widely used by majority of the people in order to do networking and connect with students and professional. I have also updated my educational section which now also includes my current degree details and an expected graduation year. In the future, I also plan to share the achievements and projects which I either complete or achieve on LinkedIn. Also, I aim to build a very strong network by coming in contacts with my seniors and mentors via this platform. This is necessary in order to gain guidance and stay focussed towards my main goal.

- **Kaggle:** It is widely used for data science and machine learning by almost everyone. It provides real-world datasets, notebooks, and competitions. The

main reason to use it so that I can or work on my analytical thinking and improve my problem-solving skills by taking the help of datasets and also participating in real – life hackathons or competitions in order to gain necessary exposure. Not to forget that this will also help me in gaining practical experience to handle real – world data.

Future Plans: -

In the next four years, I have planned to use these three platforms in a very structured manner while also being consistent which is necessary to support my overall growth. For me, GitHub will be used as the main project portfolio, which is necessary to make sure that every important project I build is saved and properly documented on the platform and can be showcased in the future.

On LinkedIn, I will try to keep my profile active by making sure to post regularly regarding my learning progress, achievement as well as internships which I will get along the way. Kaggle is also very crucial. There my main focus will be to focus on data-related problems and improve my skills in that field.

Along with all this, I also plan to look at other opportunities such as internships, or collaborate with other devs and get exposure to new technologies with the help of these platforms. This is important, as I won't just improve my technical skills but also work towards and improve my communication and professional skills as these are very important for a good future in this field.

Task – 3

Coding Practice Problem:

In order to complete the task for the coding practice task, I initially created an account on HackerRank and also did a beginner level programming challenge. Coding platforms like HackerRank are very important as they provide structured programming problems which help several beginners practice concepts in a very practical manner. I completed a few basic python problems to gain proper knowledge regarding the concepts of python language. While most of the problems attempted were basic, it helped me a lot in order to understand how the platform works and also how coding problems are evaluated.

While solving the challenge, I also got to learn about several crucial and important topics of such platforms. These platforms also allow the users to write the code directly on an editor which is online and we can also test our solutions directly.

Key things I have so far practiced on this platform are:

- I can create as well as set up my coding profile.
- Getting the opportunity to understand how coding problems are structured.
- Getting the chance to write the code using the platforms online editor.

All such exposure has helped me a lot in becoming familiar with competitive coding as well as programming environments.

Google Workspace Collaboration:

In order to complete the collaborative part of the assignment, I used Google forms which are useful in creating a Digital Literacy Awareness. The form which I created consisted of five questions which were designed in order to test the basic awareness about online safety as well as responsible internet usage. Not just MCQ's I also included short – answer questions in order to make the quiz more interactive as well as informative.

Once I created the quiz, I also connected this particular form to the google sheets so that every response submitted through the form is automatically stored in the spreadsheet. This also makes it very easy to collect the data from different responses from multiple students as well as batch mates.

Important features which were added in Google Forms are:

- Adding questions of different types.
- Making sure the structure is very simple and quite clear.
- Also, being able to view the responses in a very organised and simple manner.
- Sharing the link of the forms with others.
- Automatically recording different responses in google sheets and that too automatically.

Academic Benefits of These Tools:

These platforms are very important as they helped me to understand how such tools support both learning and collaboration in academics. Such platforms are very useful for developing skills in programming as well as improving thinking logically. Regular as well as consistent practice can help a lot in interviews and technical tests.

Also, google forms are sheets were also very useful and beneficial in projects and group work. These tools also allow students to conduct required surveys very quickly and easily. Overall, this activity, helped me learn how such tools can be used to upskill myself in such fields.

Task – 4

Introduction:

Poor digital communication is very problematic that can lead to misunderstandings as well as problems in any environments be it academic or professional. Due to this many conversations happen through emails and apps. Also, it becomes important to communicate properly as well as clearly. It is crucial to write the messages with proper context otherwise the receiver might misunderstand the attention.

Example of Poor Communication:

One particular situation where an example of poor communication can be showcased is that when a student sends an unclear or an informal message, such as “I can’t submit the assignment, increase the deadline.” Without adding any greeting or any explanation which might sound very rude or even unprofessional. Due to this, the professor might refuse even the request or also develop an impression which is not positive towards the student.

How It can be Improved:

Such problems are very easy to avoid. In order to avoid them without any issue try to write messages in a very clear as well as respectful manner. In a proper email a polite greeting must be included along with a brief explanation of the situation as well as proper concluding line with a formal request in the end. The student can also clearly explain the reasons for delay as well as even ask

for an extension in a polite as well as a formal tone. It is also very important to understand that whatever message is being said must be said using the correct grammar and wording. Being polite, organized and even clear in digital communication helps a lot in maintaining professionalism as well as preventing and kinds of misunderstandings.

Task – 5

What Surprised me During the Research:

While researching for cybercrime, the most unique or surprising thing which I found is that how easy it is for people to become victims without using any advanced hacking. Several, cybercrimes which also includes UPI as well as online payment frauds, mainly happen due to the attackers using psychological tricks rather than technical attacks. Fraudsters generally or mainly try to pretend to be officials from bank, or even customer support agents or even buyers from online marketplaces. This creates a sense of urgency or even a sense of pressure due to which the victim quickly follows the instructions. It was also quite surprising for me to know that many people lose their money due to them not fully understanding how such digital payment systems work. For example, many people still believe that by entering the pin they receive money but actually PIN always authorizes sending money.

Habit I will Personally Change:

Another thing which I found or observed during my research was how quickly college students and young people are easily targeted. Since students mostly use digital tools for several purposes, they are mostly exposed to such threats and scams which also involve fake payment requests or even malicious links.

As a result of all of this learning about risks, one habit I will be definitely change is that I will be more cautious before even approving any such online payment request. I will always first verify any source of payment, avoid scanning any unknown QR codes and even carefully check transaction details

before entering my UPI PIN in order to make sure my financial security online is safe and secure.

Conclusion

Completing this particular Digital Literacy Portfolio project helped me a lot in understanding the importance of digital skills in academic as well as professional life. Through the different tasks, I have also explored several online tools and platforms which also support learning and communication. Also, while creating as well as organizing a GitHub repository helped me understand a lot as to how digital work can be properly and correctly documented as well as shared professionally.

I got to build profiles on platforms such as GitHub and LinkedIn which showed the importance of maintaining a professional presence in digital world from starting to the end of my career. The coding problems activity as well as google forms which I did also demonstrated how these digital tools can easily help students in order to practice their skills or even collaborate with others.

The email etiquette as well as cybercrime awareness tasks were very useful as they were mainly focusing on online communication which is quite responsible as well as internet practices which are safe. Overall, such kind of projects improved my awareness a lot towards digital tools as well as towards online safety and the skills I learned will be used by me throughout my career.

References:

- **Canva** – I used them for creating the infographic. <https://www.canva.com>
- **GitHub** – I used them for creating project repository. <https://github.com>
- **LinkedIn** – I used them for building a student profile.
<https://www.linkedin.com>
- **Google Forms** – I used them for creating the Quiz. <https://forms.google.com>
- **HackerRank** – I used them for completing a simple and easy coding challenge. <https://www.hackerrank.com>